



PROGRESS REPORT

Ethiopia: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 · 170 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-08.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	Digital Ethiopia 2030 was launched in December 2025 on three pillars of access, equal opportunity and trust, and is the standing national strategy. The strategy sets targets of 128m subscriptions and an identity for every adult by 2030, together with a sevenfold rise in digital payments (Digital Ethiopia 2030). The council overseeing the programme restated in July 2026 that it is to be judged on lives changed rather than systems deployed, a claim with no published measure behind it. No implementation plan, budget allocation against the pillars or progress report is held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The Digital Government Strategy and Enterprise Architecture 2024-2029 has been in force since July 2024 with no revision on the record. The strategy and its enterprise architecture were published in July 2024 and run to 2029, and remain the standing statement of how government systems are to be built (the strategy). The base holds nothing on implementation against it: no progress report, no compliance review and no register of systems assessed against the architecture.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	A government-commissioned assessment recommended a broadband plan be developed; none has been established since (assessment). The 2023 e-government assessment commissioned by the innovation and technology ministry recommended that a broadband plan be developed to guide infrastructure deployment (assessment). No such plan was located at the probe date of 28 August 2026. What moved sits alongside it. The Council of Ministers approved Digital Ethiopia 2030 in November 2025, which commits to nationwide high-speed broadband as part of the successor national digital strategy (approval). Ethiopia's broadband mapping system was introduced at a national event in October 2025, bringing the Economic Commission for Africa, the EU delegation and the ITU together to build the infrastructure evidence base for future broadband policy (event). A commitment inside a general strategy and a mapping tool are not a broadband strategy, and the base does not treat them as one.	NO CHANGE the recommended broadband plan is still not held and what moved sits alongside it
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	A sovereign cloud and a forensic laboratory are named in the national strategy as intentions, with no separate storage or cloud policy held. December 2025's national strategy places a sovereign cloud and a forensic laboratory among the foundations it sets out (Digital Ethiopia 2030). No siting decision, procurement, operator or date exists for either facility, and no data storage or cloud strategy is held as a document in its own right.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	The e-government interoperability framework has been in development since July 2024 and the base records no completion. The framework was published in July 2024 and is recorded as still in development two years on (the framework). No adopted version, compliance mandate or list of systems built to it is held, which is the gap the approved national data exchange platform would have to close.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	A national artificial intelligence policy adopted in 2024 is in force, known to the base only at second hand. The policy was adopted in 2024 and its existence reaches the base through a July 2026 account of the country joining a Shanghai-based cooperation body (policy in force). The policy text, its objectives, any implementation plan and any review are all absent, so what is recorded is that a policy exists and not what it says.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	The security agency announced a home-grown government cloud framed expressly as implementing data localisation (announcement). The Information Network Security Administration announced Gotera Cloud, a home-grown government cloud offering infrastructure, platform, software and backup services, framed expressly as implementing data localisation and data sovereignty (announcement). The Council of Ministers approved Digital Ethiopia 2030 in November 2025, a strategy centred on sovereign national cloud and domestic data governance (approval). The base holds an infrastructure build and a strategy commitment, and no rule: nothing on the record requires any class of data to be stored in Ethiopia, and the data protection proclamation's cross-border provisions are not framed as localisation.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A national data governance strategy is being drafted around named use cases in health, agriculture and public financial management. The strategy is being anchored in concrete use cases rather than written first and applied afterwards, with agriculture and public financial management the test domains alongside health (use-case approach). No draft text, adopting instrument or timetable is published, so the approach is on the record and the policy itself is not.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	A government-commissioned assessment recommended reviving the failed common open-data portal (assessment). The 2023 e-government assessment found no open-data sharing between institutions and recommended reviving the common open-data portal (assessment). Digital Ethiopia 2030, approved by the Council of Ministers in November 2025, commits to a national data authority and structured government data (approval). Ethiopia OpenAgriNet launched in February 2026 on open standards with consent-based data governance, the clearest sectoral operationalisation of open-data principles in the window (launch). The open-data policy guideline was recorded as still in draft in 2018 (supervision report) and the base holds no later statement that it was adopted, so the policy instrument itself has not moved in eight years.	NO CHANGE the open-data policy guideline recorded as draft in 2018 is still not held as adopted
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	Proclamation 1321/2024 has been in force since July 2024, a comprehensive regime with extraterritorial reach and no secondary directives behind it. The proclamation took effect on 24 July 2024 as a comprehensive personal data regime reaching beyond the country's borders (Proclamation 1321/2024). What the base does not hold is any instrument under it: the directives that would give the proclamation operative content were still unissued a year after commencement (a year on).	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	Proclamation 1426/2026 designates twelve critical sectors and places eighteen obligations on their owners and operators, commencing about July 2027. The proclamation was signed at Addis Ababa on 21 July 2026, and article 28 sets commencement one year after gazettment (Proclamation 1426/2026). The designated sectors run from information and communications technology, financial services and transport to agriculture, trade and industry; a Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Fund is established, and the security agency is to write sector standards, give technical assistance and enforce through the transition (briefing on the proclamation). Ratification, assent and commencement dates are not established in the base, and the regulations the Council of Ministers and the agency may make under articles 26 and 27 do not yet exist.	ADVANCED

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Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The 2023 identification proclamation became a binding operational requirement across banking, with migration to the new verification service mandated (decision). The central bank and the national identity programme began harmonising all bank customer account numbers with the national digital identity, mandating migration from the first to the second verification service for all new and existing accounts with a deadline of 30 March 2026 (decision). The government stated in December 2025 that 30 million citizens had been registered and that the identity had been carried into Digital Ethiopia 2030 with integration planned down to the lowest administrative levels (statement). The statute itself was not amended in the window; what moved is the weight placed on it (Digital Identification Proclamation 1284/2023). The base holds no statutory limit on state access to identity data and no redress route for a registrant, which is carried separately as a not-held position.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	The central bank widened its virtual-asset prohibition to the whole category, and a court struck down a decree revoking licences without a court order. A central-bank public notice of 23 July 2026 widened the prohibition by clarification rather than by new rule, covering use, purchase, sale, exchange, transfer, trading, settlement and facilitation absent express authorisation, with no new regulation and no enforcement mechanism announced (public notice). The Federal High Court of Lideta struck down a December 2025 lottery-administration decree that had cut banking services to betting platforms and gateways, holding revocation of a licence without a court order unconstitutional (the ruling). No payments proclamation or electronic transactions statute is held, so the operative law reaches the base as directives, notices and one judgment.	MIXED the central bank widened a prohibition by notice while a court struck down a decree
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	No instrument compels agencies to integrate with the unified service platform, on its own regional executives' account. Regional executives of the unified public-service platform say no legal framework obliges agencies to join it, so integration rests on agreement between them (platform review). The base holds no interoperability proclamation, no data-sharing regulation and no mandate under the e-government interoperability framework, which has itself been in development since 2024.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	An implementing directive gave the security agency power to designate new and emerging technology products for clearance (directive). Directive 1135/2026, made under the Information Technology Products Security Clearance and Control Proclamation, creates security clearance, permit and monitoring procedures for restricted and prohibited information technology products and provides for the designation of new or emerging products — a power wide enough to reach advanced artificial-intelligence systems (directive). The only instrument addressed to artificial intelligence as such remains the National Artificial Intelligence Policy adopted by the Council of Ministers in June 2024, a policy rather than a binding statute (policy). The base holds no AI act, no draft bill and no regulator with an artificial-intelligence mandate, so what governs AI here is import control and general policy.	ADVANCED on a security-clearance directive rather than on any statute addressed to artificial intelligence

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	A draft amendment would add service provider duties, site blocking and take-down notices to the 2004 copyright proclamation, the first platform-liability instrument held. The intellectual property authority reported in August 2026 that the amendment is being drafted after several consultation rounds, and would put duties on internet service providers, set procedures for blocking infringing sites and create a rights-holder take-down notice (the authority's account). Enforcement would stay rights-holder-initiated and by web address, because channel operators cannot be identified, against existing remedies of one-to-ten-year sentences and fines to 25,000 Birr (the same report). A draft proclamation ratifying accession to the Berne Convention is before the Council of Ministers, with no parliamentary date published (the report again).	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	A successor statistics proclamation was approved by the House on 30 June 2026, replacing the 2005 statute (approval). The Council of Ministers referred the draft Ethiopian Statistics Proclamation to the House of People's Representatives on 26 May 2026 (referral), and the House approved it on 30 June 2026, intended to strengthen the statistics service's independence and align the national statistical system with international statistical principles (approval). The statute it replaces is Proclamation 442/2005, which established the Central Statistics Authority as an autonomous federal agency with legal personality and defined the national statistical programme (Proclamation 442/2005). No gazette text or proclamation number for the new law had been located at the probe date of 28 August 2026, so what is held is the approval, not the enacted text.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	The state development bank adopted a policy classifying client credit information and four other categories as permanently non-disclosable. The policy, reported in August 2026, exempts client credit information, legal case files, strategy papers, security protocols and third-party contracts from declassification where disclosure could cause substantial harm to the bank, its stakeholders or the national interest, and lets the bank decline requests that would require it to create records it does not hold (disclosure policy). No instrument number, gazette reference or appeal mechanism is stated, and the base holds no general access-to-information statute against which to read it.	REGRESSED
Data protection	Data protection authority	The communications authority is the designated regulator, and a year after commencement it had taken no enforcement action. The proclamation names the Ethiopian Communications Authority as regulator rather than creating a dedicated body (Proclamation 1321/2024). A year after commencement the authority had yet to enforce and public awareness was low, on a base where the national identity authenticates about 4m times a day across more than 150 agencies (a year on). No budget, staffing figure, register of controllers or decision of any kind is held for the authority in its data-protection role.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data protection	National data protection readiness	No independent impact assessment, redress mechanism or statutory limit on state access to the identity system is held, against 46.5m registrations. A published critique argues the identity system risks becoming an instrument of mass profiling in the absence of independent data-protection impact assessments, meaningful citizen rights and legal limits on state access (critique). In August 2026 the foreign ministry circulated a note asking every accredited diplomatic mission and international organisation to submit lists and addresses of all Ethiopian and foreign employees without diplomatic privileges, together with tenant and landlord details (diplomatic note). No legal basis, retention rule, data controller or purpose limitation is stated in the note as reported. The regulator now says the secondary law is coming: four directives are expected to be approved in the coming months and a registration portal for data controllers and processors has been previewed, an early step towards a national register of them. The directives are unpublished, the portal was shown at a workshop co-hosted with a vendor, and a year after the proclamation took effect nothing has been enforced under it.	REGRESSED
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	Identity cooperation was agreed with Zambia in March 2026, and a three-year memorandum with Mozambique followed in April. The Mozambique memorandum was signed at Addis Ababa on 27 April 2026 between Mozambique's digital transformation agency and the Ethiopian state digital-identity enterprise, and is extendable by consent (memorandum). Under it the Ethiopian side provides digital-identity, pilot, interoperability and joint-cybersecurity support, coordinated through a joint working group (trade account). The Zambian arrangement is recorded only as identity cooperation agreed, with no text, term or scope on the record (Zambia integrator search). A delegation attended the UNDP Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure session of 2-3 September 2026 alongside four other countries, on moving DPI blueprints to execution, verifiable credentials and consented data sharing, and reusable open-source deployment blueprints. No country programme, commitment or deliverable follows from it on the record.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	Ethiopia completed the validation stage of its continental free trade implementation review, intended to guide domestic regulatory alignment (validation). Ethiopia completed the final validation stage of its African Continental Free Trade Area implementation review in August 2026, using the continental review matrix, intended to guide policy and regulatory reform aligning domestic rules with continental trade commitments (validation). At the third IGAD ministerial conference on labour and migration in October 2025, with Ethiopia's state minister among signatories, the communique welcomed a single visa initiative through harmonised visa systems and recorded that millions of the region's citizens lack legal identification or hold identity documents unsuitable for the digital age (communique). Ethiopia ratified the 2023 IGAD Treaty in April 2024, the operative instrument for its standing in the regional harmonisation framework (ratification). These are commitments to harmonise rather than harmonised rules; the base holds no domestic instrument amended to match a regional one.	ADVANCED

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Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	A terrestrial corridor with Djibouti, Sudan and Saudi Arabia entered active deployment in August 2026, having become binding in February. The December 2024 memorandum between the three national operators became a binding agreement in February 2026 (binding agreement). By August the end-to-end solution architecture was finalised and site-material procurement complete, with the stated route extended to Jeddah (deployment). No route length, cost, in-service date or transit-revenue projection is published, so the transit-hub claim rests on the corridor's geography alone, and one of the four territories it crosses is at war.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	A bilateral health memorandum provides for a data-sharing arrangement still to be negotiated, expected to run two years beyond its five-year term. Clause 2.5.2 of the December 2025 memorandum has the two governments intending to negotiate an arrangement for exchanging data on long-term performance and for accountability to the United States Congress, and clause 4.7 makes failure to fulfil the specimen and data sharing arrangements grounds for changing or discontinuing assistance, although the memorandum creates no specimen arrangement (memorandum). A rights organisation reading the seven signed memoranda puts Ethiopia among five whose text requires unilateral sharing of specimens and pathogen-sequencing data, and all seven as requiring broad audit access (assessment); no arrangement text is published, and a subset posted by the State Department in March 2026 was removed (records complaint).	ADVANCED
Standards	National interoperability standards	The government interoperability framework remains the standing instrument, listed as approved and not superseded (repository entry). The interoperability framework of record is the Ethiopian Government Interoperability Framework, carried as approved in the innovation and technology ministry's own guidelines and standards repository (repository entry). Digital Ethiopia 2030, approved in November 2025, commits to interoperable digital systems (approval), but names no standard and supersedes no framework. The repository entry is a document-library listing rather than the framework text, so the base holds that the framework exists and is current without holding what it requires.	NO CHANGE
Standards	National quality standards	National livestock data standards were endorsed in July 2026 and cascaded through training of trainers to more than 300 experts and collectors. The standards were developed with the agriculture ministry, endorsed, and then cascaded on a training-of-trainers model (livestock data standards). They underpin a livestock information system drawing on five priority databases, which repositions animal identification from an export tool to a national asset register and links it to disease surveillance and vaccination records (the same account). The account is the implementing organisation's own, after four years with a team embedded in the ministry, and is uncorroborated in the base. 2026-09-06 - a standing readiness instrument the base had not held was named from practice: a central bank microfinance directive of 2022 already defines the governance, risk-management and operational readiness institutions skip when they buy digital wallets before building the capability to run them. The directive text is not held, and no supervisory finding or compliance count is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	Adoption of international standards	The national identity is built on an open-source international platform and is the reference deployment other implementations point to. The platform is modular open source under the Mozilla Public Licence, incubated at a research institute in Bangalore, and the Ethiopian deployment is its flagship (platform account). That adoption is the base's clearest evidence of an international standard taken up, and its only one: no conformity assessment, standards-body membership or certification against international instruments is on the record.	NO CHANGE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	A civil-society project on climate disinformation launched in August 2026 will track government communications ahead of the November climate conference. The project covers Uganda and Ethiopia under a wider international initiative, and combines research mapping how climate disinformation spreads and who drives it with a fact-checking masterclass at the 2026 internet-freedom forum and online training for journalists and civil society (project launch). No budget or duration is stated, and the base holds no other instance of non-governmental input to national digital policy: no consultation record, no submission and no published response to one.	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	Public argument over telecommunications reform has moved from whether to liberalise to whether the state is provider or regulator. The monopoly ended in 2021 with one new full licensee since, and the published debate now turns on whether the state should act as provider or as regulator and partner (reform commentary). That is the only held instance of open policy argument, and it is a newspaper commentary rather than a consultation, a hearing record or a government response to either.	NO CHANGE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	Digital lines in the federal budget rose to ETB 9.05bn for FY2026/27 from ETB 3.75bn, dominated by a single university project. Thirty-four digital budget lines run across three years: ETB 1.21bn appropriated in FY2024/25 against an outturn of ETB 1.53bn, ETB 3.75bn in FY2025/26 and ETB 9.05bn in FY2026/27, the last dominated by an artificial-intelligence university line (budget lines). They sit inside a federal budget of 2.34 trillion birr for FY2026/27, ratified in July 2026 and up 21.3% on the year before (budget ratified). Execution is now published: the mid-year review for 2025/26 records ETB 704.7bn mobilised, 48.1% of the annual target, against ETB 798.2bn spent, 48.3% of the approved budget, with recurrent spending at 39.3% of its budget against 62.9% of capital (mid-year review).	ADVANCED mostly the birr float rather than real growth

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	The 2025 creditor-committee memorandum moved into implementation, with a bilateral agreement and a bondholder agreement in principle (agreement). Ethiopia concluded a memorandum of understanding with its Official Creditor Committee under the G20 Common Framework on 2 July 2025, formalising a debt treatment worth over US\$3.5bn to be implemented through bilateral agreements (memorandum). The first of those bilateral agreements was signed with Italy in Rome on 18 March 2026 (agreement). On 29 June 2026 Ethiopia reached agreement in principle with the ad hoc committee of holders of its US\$1bn 2024 notes on restructuring terms (agreement). These are financial rather than digital instruments. The base holds no memorandum tying this financing to the digital programme, so the relevance here is fiscal room rather than a digital commitment.	ADVANCED
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	The second network operator is funded to about US\$2.67bn, and a change of control over it completed in June 2026. The parent's disclosure at 30 June 2026 puts funding of the Ethiopian operator at KES 345.7bn, about US\$2.672bn: KES 298.3bn of equity and KES 47.3bn of debt from a commercial bank and the International Finance Corporation, including the US\$850m licence fee and the US\$150m mobile-money fee (funding disclosure). A funding round restricted to one shareholder family lifted the lead holding to 54.1% in March 2026 from 51.67%, cutting the two development financiers to 9.5% and 6.81% with a right to reacquire what they lost (the same disclosure). The incumbent's 10% public share offer closed in February 2025, distributed through its wallet (public offer), and the change of control completed on 30 June 2026 (completion).	ADVANCED
New investments	Development-partner project financing	The US\$350m identity credit is rated satisfactory on both counts and 23% disbursed, and a small extension grant was committed in July 2026. The identity project is an SDR 228.2m credit of US\$300m plus an SDR 38.1m grant of US\$50m from the window for host communities and refugees (appraisal). The March 2026 implementation support mission rated it satisfactory on development objective and on implementation progress, with 23% disbursed and US\$46.4m disbursed since the start of the 2026 financial year (aide-memoire). A US\$300,000 grant committed in July 2026 converts a catalytic start-up initiative into a programme delivering agricultural extension through digital channels to 2028 (extension grant). The same refugee window put US\$69m of additional financing into the education programme in March 2026, to bring all 57 refugee primary schools and their learners into the national education system and its management information system (additional financing).	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	The incumbent reports 99.8% population coverage on about 90m subscribers, and the second operator 14.7m active customers. Mobile connections reached 93.2m in late 2025, 68.4% of the population, from 85.4m and 63.8% in early 2025 (connections). The incumbent reported 99.8% population coverage in April 2026 (coverage), and the second operator 14.7m ninety-day active customers in August after upgrading more than 67 sites across nine southern towns against congestion and power problems (site upgrades). Contracts signed at the 2026 industry congress cover 1,500 new sites and 502 upgrades from one vendor and 647 from another, under a three-year corporate strategy to 2028 (expansion contracts, strategy); a review in August put 879 sites complete under the second programme (progress review).	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage	Data and internet became the incumbent's largest revenue line in the year to June 2026, at 31.1% against mobile voice at 23.5%. It was the first financial year in which data and internet, not mobile voice, were the largest share of the incumbent's revenue (data overtakes voice). Total revenue was 215.8bn birr with operating profit of 92.9bn birr, on the operator's own unaudited figures (results). A streaming service and a zero-touch broadband product launched in February 2026 (new services). No independent measure of internet use is held: the base carries revenue mix and connection counts, not a survey of users.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	The second operator raised data prices by 20 to 82 percent from December 2025 (report) while a US\$40 smartphone pilot named Ethiopia (pilot). Safaricom Ethiopia revised its data packages from 23 December 2025, raising prices by between 20 and 82 percent across most plans while cutting data volumes on several: the weekly 10GB bundle at 250 birr was reduced to 5.5GB, and the 100 birr weekly package to 2GB from 3GB (report). The operator cited operational and investment costs, the birr devaluation and prior below-cost pricing. Ethiopia was named one of six African countries for a 2026 pilot of entry-level 4G smartphones in the US\$30-40 range by the handset affordability coalition (pilot). The most recent market assessment is from July 2025 (assessment); its affordability figures are not in the captured text, so the base holds no price-to-income measure against which to size the increase.	MIXED service prices rose sharply at the second operator while a device-affordability pilot was extended to Ethiopia
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	The second operator began building fibre from Afdera to Mekelle in August 2025, the only backbone construction the base holds. Construction on that route started in August 2025 and is the only record of national fibre being built by anyone other than the incumbent (fibre deployment). No route length, capacity, cost or completion date is published, and the base holds no figure at all for the national backbone's route kilometres, its utilisation or its redundancy.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	A multi-terabit corridor to Jeddah through Djibouti and Sudan entered deployment, the first new international route the base holds. The corridor is described as multi-terabit and now runs to Saudi Arabia, which would give a landlocked country a second path to international capacity alongside its existing transit (corridor deployment). No capacity figure, in-service date or price is published, and the base holds no measurement of international bandwidth in use, per person or in total, against which to read it.	ADVANCED

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Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	The country's only internet exchange carries three members and 21 Gbps of cumulative port capacity (tracker). Measurement from self-reported peering data, last updated in January 2026, records the Addis Ababa Internet Exchange with three members, 21 Gbps of cumulative port speeds, all three members peering at the route server and two of the three using route origin validation (tracker). The exchange, the country's first, had by September 2025 been operating for over a year at a Tier III data centre in the technology park (update). The base holds no earlier capacity or membership figure, so the level is stated and the direction is not. It holds no second exchange and none outside the capital.	NO CHANGE a first measurement of the sole exchange with no earlier figure behind it
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Satellite services are licensable as a class landing-right authorisation, and no low-earth-orbit operator is authorised on the record. The licensing directive of July 2021 carries a class authorisation for satellite voice, internet and data services provided without infrastructure or a network facility in the country, one of thirteen class licences alongside internet service provider, data centre, hosting and terminal authorisations (licensing directive). There is no orbit-specific determination and no authorised operator on record, and the regulator denied in July 2025 that any discussions with a low-earth-orbit operator had taken place (the same record).	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	The country is named among markets diversifying Africa's estate, with no capacity figure of its own on the record. A July 2026 survey of African capacity names Ethiopia alongside Nigeria, Kenya, Egypt, Ghana and Morocco as markets diversifying an estate in which South Africa holds more than 60% of operational capacity (capacity survey). No megawatt figure, facility count or pipeline is given for Ethiopia itself, so the base records that the country is on the list and nothing about where on it.	NO CHANGE a first mention with no capacity figure behind it
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	An in-country cloud exchange went live in April 2026, selling compute, Kubernetes and storage priced in birr and hybrid with two global clouds. The platform offers compute, Kubernetes, drive and security services priced in local currency and interoperating with two global cloud providers, and its operator frames it as compliance with local data rules (cloud exchange). No capacity, customer count or price list is published, and the base holds no other nationally operated cloud or data centre, so this is the whole of the domestic-provider record.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity	Off-site capacity grew with a new private cloud platform and Tier III expansion, while the government's own assessed absence of a continuity plan stands (assessment). Wingu Cloud Exchange launched in March 2026, a locally hosted private cloud platform offering compute, storage, container management and security, expanding in-country off-site storage and data-residency options (launch). Ethio telecom's annual performance report for the year to June 2026 reports network and data-centre capacity expansion under its 2028 strategy, including Tier III facilities (annual report); the capacity figures are not in the captured text. The government's own 2023 assessment found neither a business continuity plan nor a disaster recovery plan in place and recommended a framework with prioritised recovery sites (assessment). Nothing since states that such a plan was adopted, so capacity has grown and the obligation to use it has not been created.	ADVANCED on commercial capacity rather than on any government continuity plan

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	A 40 MW bitcoin-mining site was completed in January 2026 with 20 MW more in progress, drawn by cheap electricity. The operator completed 40 MW at the Oromia site with a further 20 MW under construction, having weighed Nigeria for the same project before relocating it on far cheaper electricity (mining site). The load is a mining site rather than a data centre serving domestic compute, and the base holds nothing on water, on grid capacity reserved for such loads, or on the tariff the electricity is sold at.	ADVANCED
Energy	Grid reliability	Diesel generator running time across the incumbent's network is down by up to 40% on hybrid solar and battery installations. The operator reports 867 hybrid solar-and-battery systems and 1,114 lithium-ion storage units across its network, cutting diesel generator running time by up to 40% (green operator). The figures are the operator's own and unaudited, and they measure a network's dependence on its own backup rather than the grid itself: no outage statistics, interruption indices or utility disclosure are held.	ADVANCED
Energy	Rural electrification	Solar on the incumbent's network reached 39.72 MW, against rural electricity reaching 9% of community health workers. Installed solar across the incumbent's network stood at 39.72 MW in August 2026, up 12.72 MW over the financial year, on 190 fully solar-powered sites serving rural and off-grid communities (green operator). Behind that, the community health information system is offline-first by necessity because rural electricity reaches 9% of its users and fourth-generation coverage 4%, and the ministry distributed about 29,950 power banks with its tablets (community health system).	MIXED solar at network sites is rising while rural electricity behind the community health system stays at 9%
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	Services are onboarded to the unified platform before the underlying systems are digitised, on two incompatible integration models. The platform's own regional executives say services are being onboarded ahead of the digitisation of the systems that would serve them, and that two incompatible integration models have emerged as a result (platform review). The base holds no inventory of government hardware or software, no uptime figure for any government system and no assessment of the estate, so the platform's own account is the only evidence on the question.	MIXED services are being added to the unified platform ahead of the systems behind them
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	The national health information system stayed online on local staffing after the 2025 aid freeze, while donor-funded livestock and zoonotic surveillance was suspended. The 2025 United States aid freeze suspended livestock and zoonotic surveillance, while the national health information system continued to run on local staffing, which is the argument its implementers draw for locally owned routine systems (a year after the freeze). The contrast is the only direct evidence held on national capacity to keep government systems running, and it covers one sector: no civil-service skills audit, vacancy figure or maintenance contract register is on file.	MIXED the national health information system held on local staffing while donor-funded surveillance stopped
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	Cybersecurity foundations are named in the national strategy, and the dominant state bank is moving to a zero-trust architecture. The December 2025 strategy makes the security agency's cybersecurity work one of the foundations of the national programme (Digital Ethiopia 2030). The dominant state bank reported in August 2026 that it is moving its information-systems architecture to a zero-trust model supported by artificial intelligence (financial sector threats). No national readiness assessment, incident statistics, emergency response team disclosure or sectoral audit is held, so the record is a stated intention and one institution's own account.	ADVANCED

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	A national data exchange platform was approved by a prime-ministerial board in July 2026, paired with a predictive model and not yet built. The board approved the platform alongside an artificial-intelligence predictive model, at the same meeting that was diagnosing the absence of an interoperability layer (board approval). Nothing is published on architecture, budget, timetable or operator, and the interoperability framework that would govern such a platform has itself been in development since 2024, so approval is the whole of the position.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	The identity has been integrated with tax administration since December 2023 and was made mandatory for schooling in November 2025. Tax administration was integrated with the national identity in December 2023 and the base records no change since (tax integration). The mandate of November 2025 requires the identity for school enrolment and for sitting examinations (education mandate). Neither integration is described in technical terms: there is no statement of what is exchanged, under what authority, or whether the exchange runs through a shared layer or point to point.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	Health is the most fragmented sector on the record, at more than 70 siloed platforms and 200 pilots, converging on one record-interoperability pilot. Work on the data governance strategy surfaced health as the most fragmented sector, holding more than 70 siloed platforms and more than 200 pilots, and it is converging on a multi-tenant electronic medical record interoperability pilot (use cases). The pilot has no published scope, participating facilities or date, and the base holds no health information exchange, no terminology standard and no patient identifier arrangement.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	Refugee schools are being integrated into the national education information system under a funded package (programme paper). A US\$69m additional financing package approved in March 2026 integrates all 57 refugee primary schools into the national education system, including full integration of refugee learners into the national education information system, with US\$750,000 earmarked for enhancement and disaggregated reporting (programme paper). The adoption of DHIS2 for Education in November 2025 was framed explicitly as operationalising the ministry's national education information system at local levels so that local data can be used where it is collected (launch). Both are integrations into one sector's system. The base holds nothing on education data exchanging with the national data exchange platform, the civil register or the digital identity.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	A US\$200m successor safety-net project moved the national social registry from appraisal into funded implementation (approval). The World Bank board approved the sixth Productive Safety Net Project in March 2026, a US\$200m credit committing to stronger digital tools and improved monitoring behind safety-net delivery and moving the national social registry from appraisal into funded implementation (approval). The founding requirement is the 2023 digital identity financing agreement, which requires a digital stack including a whole-of-government data exchange platform and open APIs, and prioritises integration into public services including social protection (financing agreement). The base holds the commitment and the money. It holds no statement that the social registry actually exchanges data with the identity system, the civil register or the payment rails.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	The programme adopted an open external assessment framework as its official monitoring instrument and re-ran it in May 2026. The assessment was first run in early 2025 and re-run in May 2026, and the identity programme has adopted it as its official monitoring instrument rather than commissioning its own (assessment). The scores, findings and any remediation plan are not held, so the base records that the system is being measured and not what the measurement says. The deployment is the flagship implementation of the platform it is built on, which other national programmes take as their reference (platform account).	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	Enrolment reached 49.1m by August 2026 from 16.4m in June 2025, on 12,000 registration kits, against a 90m target. Enrolments stood at 49.1m on 24 August 2026, from about 46.5m in July and 16.4m in June 2025, on 12,000 biometric registration kits deployed nationally (enrolment count). The second operator took two lots of the registration project in July 2026, covering Afar, Amhara, Tigray, Sidama and three southern regions (registration lots), and a four-lot procurement of about US\$54m for registration super agents awaits the lender's clearance (aide-memoire). 2026-09-07 - the enrolment rules reached the base for the first time: the programme's own list of 33 accepted proof-of-identity documents, from the local administration card and passport to birth, education, marriage and business records, and the documents foreign nationals must present - an origin card and passport for those of Ethiopian origin, a residence or work permit plus passport for other foreign residents, and a valid refugee card for recognised refugees. Neither carries its own issue date.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	The identity programme was incorporated as a state-owned enterprise in August 2026 under the sovereign wealth fund, and plans to widen its wallet. The programme was commercialised into the sovereign wealth fund with a 10bn birr cap in March 2026 (wealth fund), then incorporated as a state-owned enterprise on 4 August 2026 with the programme's executive director appointed chief executive (enterprise). The holding company states the purpose as attracting partnerships and creating long-term value, and positions the enterprise for export (the same account). The wallet is planned to carry academic transcripts, professional licences, healthcare records, property titles and compliance data beyond the government credentials it holds today, with no timetable, consent model, controller arrangement or regulatory approval stated (wallet expansion).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	194m identity verifications have been performed across 150 integrated agencies, and biometric kits have gone to banks. The programme reports 194m electronic know-your-customer verifications to date across 150 integrated agencies, on its own unaudited figures (verification count). Two thousand portable face, fingerprint and iris kits were distributed to 31 banks in November 2025 of 6,000 planned, at about US\$17m, with the remaining 4,000 under a re-issued tender (biometric kits). No authentication failure rate, exception-handling procedure or availability figure is published.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	Birth registration is being extended operationally, including backlog clearance for refugee children in Afar (mission). A joint field mission by the refugee service with UNICEF, UNHCR and the Immigration and Citizenship Service cleared birth-registration backlogs and assessed service delivery for refugee children in Semera and Asayita refugee camp in April 2026 (mission). The government's own account of civil registration digitalisation describes family and vital-event registration running digitally from the central level down to woreda level (statement). The base holds no birth-registration rate, and nothing states whether a registered birth produces a national identity number, so the link this indicator asks about is not evidenced either way.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position with nothing measuring registration at birth
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	All bank accounts were required to be harmonised with the identity by March 2026, and one bank now opens accounts on it alone. The December 2025 directive required every bank account to be harmonised with the national identity by 30 March 2026 (banking integration). A commercial bank opened the first accounts on the identity alone in April 2026, without other documents (remote account opening). Nothing is held on compliance with the deadline: no share of accounts harmonised, no extension and no enforcement action is on the record.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The central bank published a five-year payments strategy in December 2025 and directed the banking system to harmonise accounts with the national identity. The strategy for 2026 to 2030 was published against 18.5tn birr a year in digital transactions (payments strategy). The following day the bank set a March 2026 deadline for full integration of the national identity with the banking system (banking integration). The bank's supervisory record is thinner than its strategy: no licensing register, supervisory report or consumer-complaint statistics are held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	Finance, the central bank and the national switch convened government institutions to operationalise interoperable government payments (report). In July 2026 the finance ministry, the central bank and the national switch convened technical teams from government institutions to operationalise a unified implementation framework for interoperable person-to-government and government-to-person payments, aligned to the national digital payments strategy (report). The rails behind it were launched at the December 2025 payments conference, which recorded both the draft national digital payments strategy and the instant payment system (conference). The national switch's own annual report for the year to June 2025 sets out its mandate over interoperability, the national payment scheme and the national payment gateway, and carries government payment work as a project under implementation rather than a live service (annual report). The base holds no volume or value of government payments actually made over these rails.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	A mobile wallet began collecting regional tax in July 2026, described as the first of a planned series with regional revenue authorities. The service went live with one regional revenue authority in July 2026 (regional tax payment). No collection volume, taxpayer count or fee arrangement is published, and the base holds nothing on federal revenue collected through digital channels, which is the larger question.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	Federal public bodies must now accept payment from any licensed provider (directive), and an electronic invoicing layer was established. Directive 1069/2025, signed by the finance minister in May 2025, requires all federal public bodies to accept payment from any licensed payment service provider – cards, prepaid instruments, mobile wallets, mobile and internet banking and bank transfers – and to integrate their collection systems with authorised gateways (directive). Directive 1142/2026 established the electronic invoicing administration layer, requiring taxpayers to use an authorised electronic invoice registration system and setting rules for sales-registration system providers (directive). The national payments conference of December 2025 recorded the launch of the draft national digital payments strategy and of the instant payment system, the rails both directives depend on (conference). The base holds the obligations, not compliance: nothing counts the public bodies that have integrated.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	An instant payment system launched in February 2026 across 32 banks and 12 microfinance institutions, with merchant and cash-out services added since. The national instant payment system carries account-to-account and wallet-to-wallet transfers with a national quick-response standard and aliases (instant payments). The switch behind it links the challenger wallet to more than 30 banks and wallets in real time, with merchant payments at more than 50,000 merchants (switch integration). Cardless cash withdrawals with one bank went live in August 2026, authorised in the app before cash is dispensed (cardless withdrawals), and prepaid electricity became purchasable in the wallet in July (electricity payments). Cardless ATM withdrawal, live with one bank since August 2026, was extended to a second bank's ATM network by 8 September 2026, authorised in the wallet app and settled in real time. The date it went live with the second bank is not established.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	The incumbent's wallet reports 60.6m users and 4.19tn birr transacted in the year to June 2026, against 2.58m monthly active users on the challenger. The incumbent's wallet moved 4.19tn birr in the year to June 2026, about 11bn birr a day, across 60.6m users, 410,700 agents and 440,100 merchants, with 21.64m customers on digital credit and microfinance (wallet results). The challenger reports monthly active users doubled to 2.58m in the quarter to June 2026 and registered merchants up 147.7% to 89,877, while mobile money is about 2% of the unit's service revenue against 45.6% in Kenya (quarterly results); the base also holds 5.2m active users for the quarter to December 2025, and the two counts are not reconciled (earlier count). The dominant state bank reports 3.48 billion digital transactions worth more than 22 trillion birr in 2025/26, which it puts at about 70 per cent of national digital transaction value (bank figures). The Global Findex 2025 reading puts account ownership at 49 per cent of adults in 2024, up three points from 46 per cent in 2021, against more than 200 million digital accounts opened over the period, with financial literacy, limited smartphone access and physical distance named as what still excludes. Accounts opened and adults included move in opposite directions and nothing reconciles the two.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	International card acceptance went live through the national switch in November 2025, and the payments strategy proposes first outbound transfers. The national switch and an international card network brought international acceptance live in November 2025 (card acceptance). The payments strategy published a fortnight later proposes the country's first outbound cross-border transfers, which are not currently permitted (payments strategy). No transaction volume, corridor or remittance figure is held, and the base records nothing on inbound remittance channels, which are the larger cross-border flow.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	The central bank moved from rule to enforcement, ordering banks and payment issuers to implement fraud-warning measures (campaign). The central bank launched a customer fraud awareness messaging campaign in March 2026, instructing banks, payment instrument issuers and microfinance institutions to implement fraud-warning measures under the financial consumer protection directive's own articles, in response to a rise in impersonation scams over messaging apps, text and telephone (campaign). It ran its first annual financial literacy week in October 2025 under a consumer-protection theme, with outreach on mobile money use and digital risks such as fraud and data misuse (launch). The operative instrument is the financial consumer protection directive issued in August 2020, which covers mobile wallets and mobile and internet banking explicitly and sets liability for unauthorised and mistaken transactions (directive). The base holds no complaint volumes, redress outcomes or fraud losses, so enforcement is visible and its effect is not.	ADVANCED
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Civil register	A home-grown national civil registration architecture was set out with a phased rollout plan, and the register was extended to refugees (presentation). Ethiopia's national electronic civil registration and vital statistics architecture — home-grown, decentralised and multi-tenant — was presented in July 2026 with its phased pilot-to-national rollout plan (presentation). The refugee service and the Immigration and Citizenship Service ran a joint training of trainers, financed by UNICEF, implementing the updated civil registration system for refugees under the amended proclamation (training). The city-level pilot established connectivity from the central level down to woreda level, with family and vital-event registration running digitally (statement). The base holds architecture and plans, and no registration coverage rate for births or deaths.	ADVANCED
Registries	Address register	Nationwide expansion of the digital address system to all urban centres was named a priority (report). The Space Science and Geospatial Institute stated that Digital Ethiopia 2030 makes nationwide expansion of the national digital address system to all urban centres a named priority (report). The institute's mandate to build and administer geospatial data including a digital addressing system rests on the 2022 regulation establishing it (regulation). The base holds a priority and a mandate, and no count of addresses assigned or urban centres covered.	ADVANCED
Registries	Business register	First-time central bank account numbers are now issued to new traders through the customs single window, removing a separate registration step (service). The central bank and the customs commission introduced a digital service issuing first-time account numbers to newly licensed importers and exporters directly through the customs electronic single window, removing a separate registration step and tightening interoperability of trade registration data (service). The founding instrument is the 2016 Commercial Registration and Business Licensing Proclamation, which establishes the nationwide central commercial register and trade name register and is carried as in force in the justice ministry's law catalogue (proclamation). The base holds no count of registered businesses and no measure of how much of the register is digital.	ADVANCED
Registries	Social protection register	The national social registry moved from a concept-stage activity into funded implementation (approval). The concept-stage project document of June 2025 named development and rollout of a national social registry as a project activity, showing it as a build rather than an established system at appraisal (project document). The World Bank board approved the US\$200m sixth Productive Safety Net Project in March 2026, moving that registry into funded implementation (approval). The programme's existing management information system is further advanced: 444 of 492 woredas use it for programme tracking and 5.1 of 7.9 million beneficiaries' data had been synchronised to the federal system, with 252 woredas on electronic payments (restructuring paper). A registry and a programme management system are different things, and the base holds no enrolment figure for the registry itself.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Electoral register	The electoral roll and its registration framework rest on the 2019 electoral proclamation, unchanged in the window (proclamation). The controlling instrument is the 2019 electoral proclamation, which defines the electoral roll and the voter and candidate registration framework and confirms the national election board as the impartial election administration (proclamation). The voter and candidate registration system and the count of voters registered for the seventh general election are carried on the ledger from April 2026 and nothing in the window moved them. The base holds no statement on whether the electoral roll is checked against the civil register or the national digital identity.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Tax register	A directive materially widened who must enter the value-added tax register, with a 30-day window for those already affected (directive). Directive 1104/2025, issued by the finance ministry in September 2025 under the value-added tax proclamation, expanded who must register: Category A taxpayers, mandatory and voluntary book-keepers, businesses with turnover above two million birr, and specified professional-service providers below that threshold, with a 30-day registration window for existing affected taxpayers (directive). The statutory basis is the 2016 federal tax administration proclamation, which requires taxpayer registration and establishes the taxpayer identification number (proclamation). The base holds no count of registered taxpayers before or after the widening, so the size of the change is not measurable from it.	ADVANCED
Registries	Land register	A cloud-hosted land services platform integrated with the national identity and payment systems is in service, with nothing published about its reach. The platform carries document upload, electronic signature and online payment, is integrated with the national identity and payment systems, and offers a mobile interface for citizens and officials (platform). Its own site is the held record, retrieved from a web archive after the domain failed to resolve. No parcel count, city coverage or operator is established, and a land platform whose domain does not resolve is itself the finding.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Health	The national health information system covers more than 95% of facilities at an assessed maturity of 2.81 of 5, weakest on infrastructure. The district health information system has been national since 2018 and reaches more than 95% of facilities, at a maturity of 2.81 out of 5 with information and communications infrastructure weakest at 2.14 (maturity assessment). Functionality for comparing reports received against reports expected was available in 75.0% of the data offices assessed in a four-country study run between November 2022 and July 2024 (newborn data functionality). The community system reaches about 40,000 health extension workers (community health system), and a case-management system used by 950 community health workers reports data-access time down from a month to a day (case management). A bilateral memorandum allocates US\$18,850,149 to health data systems across 2026 to 2030, with Ethiopia carrying licensing, cloud, hardware and maintenance costs (memorandum). The pharmaceuticals supply service reports a modernised and digitalised supply chain, recognised with a continental award in August 2026 (report).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Education	The education information system gained an adopted open-source platform and funded enhancement (launch). Ethiopia adopted DHIS2 for Education in November 2025, with initial implementation covering schools, woredas and zones in four regions, aimed at operationalising the ministry's national system at local levels (launch). A March 2026 additional financing package earmarked US\$750,000 for enhancement of the education information system and disaggregated reporting, alongside integration of all 57 refugee primary schools (programme paper). The evidence that the system exists and is operationally maintained is the ministry's own annual statistical abstract, produced by its education information and technology office and describing the system as available at decentralised levels (abstract). No statute establishing the system was located; the ministry's mandate rests on its own establishing proclamation.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	444 of 492 woredas use the safety-net management system, and a funded successor project committed to stronger digital tools (restructuring paper). The October 2025 restructuring paper for the adaptive safety net project records 444 of 492 woredas using the management information system for programme tracking, 5.1 of 7.9 million beneficiaries' data synchronised to the federal system, and 252 woredas on electronic payments, with full operationalisation targeted for the end of December 2025 (restructuring paper). The World Bank board approved the US\$200m sixth Productive Safety Net Project in March 2026, committing to stronger digital tools and improved monitoring behind delivery (approval). The base holds no statement that the December 2025 target was met, so the most recent coverage figures are from before the deadline they were measured against.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	A smart court system runs across 24 federal branches, and a criminal record information system gained a steering committee (launch statement). The Federal Supreme Court has developed a Smart Court System with automated voice-to-text transcription, virtual hearings, a network operations centre and an integrated case management system letting litigants track cases digitally, operating across 24 federal branches with regional expansion planned (launch statement). The justice ministry announced that a project steering committee set strategic directions for the Criminal Record Information Management System in April 2026, with no coverage figures disclosed (announcement). The standing programmatic instrument is the National Justice Sector Transformation Roadmap, whose ten pillars include digital justice transformation (roadmap). The base holds branch counts, not case volumes, and nothing on whether regional courts have followed.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	A revenue audit rested on data conflating gateway throughput with gateway revenue, restating one firm's three-year volume more than fourfold. Data compiled for a revenue audit conflated gross transaction volume with gateway revenue, restating one gateway's three-year throughput of ETB 32bn as ETB 143.9bn and taxing the difference at 30% (tax assessment). Corrected datasets issued in April 2026 were not accepted, and ETB 818m was swept from frozen accounts in May against a liability counsel puts at ETB 20-30m, with parallel sweeps against two other gateways (the same account). The overstatement exceeds ETB 111bn, against a gateway commission of about 2.5% split with the state operator (the account again). An international diagnostic of February 2025, across nine performance outcome areas, found the absence of a robust integrated tax administration information system adversely affecting the integrity of the registered taxpayer base, with online registration and updating of taxpayer details sought, electronic payment facilities not in place, and the use of electronic filing carried as an indicator in its own right (diagnostic). It is the only independent assessment of the administration's systems the base holds, and it predates the audit recorded above. An administration assessed as lacking an integrated system, and then producing a revenue assessment that conflated throughput with revenue, is one account read against the other.	REGRESSED
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	The customs commission describes its services as fully digitalised, on an electronic single window integrating more than 70 institutions (interview). The customs commission's deputy commissioner states that services are fully digitalised, with an electronic single window integrating more than 70 institutions and letting traders submit import and export requirements together, and a smart border customs management system with AI-enabled cameras covering about 50 kilometres at border stations (interview). A central bank directive of May 2026 requires the customs commission to use or integrate with the foreign exchange monitoring system to record and trace franco valuta imports digitally (directive). The transport ministry supplied electronic seals to enhance the commission's electronic cargo tracking system for origin-to-destination monitoring (donation). The claim of full digitalisation is the commission's own, with no independent measurement of clearance times or coverage on the base.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Land	Addis Ababa upgraded its land system into an integrated platform (report) while national rural registration progress was rated slow (supervision). Addis Ababa's land bureau upgraded its online tenure and electronic map system into an Integrated Land Information Management System, reporting more than 35,000 electronic map services issued since 2016 in the Ethiopian calendar, 13 modules upgraded in the fiscal year's first quarter and over 3,100 map, mortgage-block and name-transfer services delivered (report). A World Bank supervision report archived in December 2025 rated reform progress on the national rural land administration information system as slow (supervision). The system itself is the agriculture ministry's central repository for land transactions, land use and ownership (e-services), built out through the land administration programme that ran to 2024 (programme report). The registration-coverage figures behind the slow rating are not in the captured text, so the base carries the rating without the numbers.	MIXED the city land system was upgraded while national rural registration was assessed as slow

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	The unified platform's own catalogue lists more than 180 services from 23 organisations, against 41 services and 12 agencies a year earlier. The public catalogue, read in August 2026, states more than 180 government services from 23 named provider organisations, each listed with required documents, processing time and fees (service catalogue). Electronic government procurement is credited by the Auditor General with the decline in cash shortages across 163 audited federal institutions, in a report that also finds billions of Birr uncollected (audit report). The transport and logistics ministry launched three national systems with the incumbent operator: a cross-country public transport service system, an integrated fuel supply system and a national traffic point-based penalty management system. A trade magazine account of the launch is the record; no coverage, volume or data-handling rule for a penalty system keyed to drivers is published. 2026-09-06 - a service portal was built inside an agency rather than procured: the commodity exchange launched one using its own information-technology staff, replacing office visits that drew more than 150 callers a day in peak season with a stated thirty-minute service-level target. Both figures are the exchange's own.	ADVANCED

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	The capital reports 11 one-stop digital service centres carrying more than 150 services from more than 25 integrated institutions. At the close of the 2025/26 financial year the city administration reported 11 centres offering more than 150 services drawn from more than 25 integrated institutions (one-stop centres). The figures are the operator's own, given by the centre's director general to the city administration's own media network, with no transaction volumes, users served, cost, uptime or independent evaluation published, and the base holds nothing at all on any other subnational tier.	ADVANCED
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	Addis Ababa launched an integrated civil registration and residency system reaching down to woreda level (launch). The Addis Ababa city administration launched the Integrated Civil Registration and Residency Service Technology, developed by the Ethiopian Artificial Intelligence Institute, integrating vital-events registration with residency identification, with implementation scheduled across 50 woredas from 8 December 2025 (launch). The government's own account describes the pilot as having established connectivity from the central level down to woreda level using locally developed applications, with family and vital-event registration, resident services and verification running digitally (statement). The base holds this for the capital only. Nothing states how many of the country's woredas outside Addis Ababa keep records digitally, and the city's own one-stop service centres are carried on the city administration's account rather than a national programme.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	A matched study found measurably better maternal and child health delivery in woredas running the digitised community health information system (study). A propensity-score-matching study published in May 2026, on household data collected in July and August 2024, found woredas implementing the electronic community health information system had higher modern contraceptive use by 13.0 percentage points, institutional deliveries by 8.9 points and full vaccination coverage by 14.6 points than non-implementing woredas (study). The national health information system reached 72% of districts, with more than 2,975 institute, regional and woreda staff trained, alongside a new emergency-management system and event-based surveillance (report). The health ministry's annual sector performance report for 2024/25 carries a dedicated digital health chapter (annual report). The base holds district coverage, not health-post coverage, so how far digitisation reaches the last mile is not stated.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	An open-source education information system was adopted, with initial implementation covering schools and woredas in four regions (launch). Ethiopia adopted DHIS2 for Education, an open-source education management information system, with initial implementation covering schools, woredas and zones in four regions and the explicit aim of operationalising the ministry's national system at local levels (launch). A US\$69m additional financing package approved in March 2026 integrates all 57 refugee primary schools into the national education system, including into the national education information system, with US\$750,000 earmarked for enhancement and disaggregated reporting (programme paper). The funded reform behind the rollout is the girls' education and learning programme, which names digitisation of the education information system as a reform strand with rollout to primary schools planned across 4,500 schools in 150 woredas (programme document). The base holds plans and initial regions, and no count of primary schools actually reporting through the system.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices	Rural land registration runs on second-level certification and a national rural land administration information system (programme report). The land administration programme's completion report, covering 2011 to 2024, records the digitalisation of rural land administration through second-level land certification and the National Rural Land Administration Information System, endorsed as the national land registry system (programme report). The captured text of that report reaches only its table of contents, so the number of woredas operating the system is not something the base can state, and its publication date is a proxy taken from the stated project period. The base holds no separate account of registry offices outside land — civil, business or vehicle registration at woreda level — so this indicator rests on one sector.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position with no earlier figure behind it

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations	The police referral application and unmanned service centres were connected to the national digital identity (statement). The Federal Police Commission, meeting with deputy commissioners from all regional states, stated that the police referral application and unmanned police service centres are connected to the Fayda national digital identity, converting manual identification and investigation tasks into digital workflows (statement). The Prime Minister announced the first unmanned or smart police service in February 2026 as part of the Digital Ethiopia 2030 law-enforcement reform (message); that is a pilot in the capital. The base holds no count of rural police stations with digital case or record systems, and nothing distinguishes rural from urban in either account, so this indicator rests on a national identity link and an urban pilot.	ADVANCED on national police identity workflows rather than measured rural station coverage

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	The state artificial intelligence institute, established in 2020, built the unified service platform and anchors the state's capability claim. The institute has operated since 2020 and is credited with building the unified public-service platform, which is the state's principal claim to applied artificial intelligence capability (the institute). Nothing else is held: no inventory of models in government use, no procurement, no evaluation of any deployed system and no policy on automated decision-making within administration.	NO CHANGE
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	Artificial intelligence entered sectoral systems in agriculture, health and cross-government monitoring (platform). A national conference reported a unified digital monitoring and evaluation platform across more than 113 public institutions, with an AI-powered survey dashboard (platform). Ethiopia OpenAgriNet launched in February 2026, an AI-powered agricultural platform built on open standards with consent-based data governance, developed by the Agricultural Transformation Institute with partners (launch). The research institute and the health ministry completed training on AI-PRESCRIBER, a clinical decision support system, with specialists from 13 hospitals each delegating one expert (training). These are launches and trainings. The base holds no usage figure, no accuracy or safety evaluation, and no statement that any of them has changed a sectoral decision.	ADVANCED
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	Generative artificial intelligence services are sold as bundles through a mobile wallet, and no nationally developed model is held. Bundles for generative application, website, game, video and music creation went on sale in July 2026 through the challenger's wallet, bought with mobile money and redeemed by voucher (service bundles). The base holds no nationally or regionally developed model, no training dataset, no compute facility and no research output, so what is recorded is the distribution of services built elsewhere.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Control of AI abuse	A security-clearance directive reached new and emerging technology products, and an AI readiness assessment was used to identify governance gaps (directive). Directive 1135/2026 creates security clearance, permit and monitoring procedures for restricted and prohibited information technology products and provides for designating new or emerging products (directive). UNESCO reported that a creative-industries forum in Addis Ababa in June 2026 surfaced findings from Ethiopia's AI readiness assessment, used to identify governance gaps and reform priorities for responsible artificial intelligence (report). The governing instrument remains the 2024 National Artificial Intelligence Policy, a Council of Ministers policy rather than binding law (policy). The base holds no rule on automated decision-making, no complaint or redress route for an AI-caused harm, and no enforcement action.	ADVANCED on import control and diagnosis rather than on any rule addressed to AI harms
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	The base names one domestic engineering firm and one foreign entrant with a local partner, with no measure of national production. An Addis Ababa engineering services firm founded in 2021 is the only named domestic producer on the record (engineering firm). A South African financial-technology firm entered the payments market in August 2026 with a local engineering partner, aligning onboarding, fraud-management and workflow-automation tools with the national payments strategy, with no commitment value, customer or deployment date disclosed (market entry). No industry survey, employment figure, export value or firm count is held.	NO CHANGE two firms named and no output measured
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	An artificial intelligence innovation pod opened in February 2026, run with a development agency and the national university. The pod opened in February 2026 with the United Nations Development Programme and Addis Ababa University (innovation pod). It is the only hub the base holds: no incubator count, membership figure, funding total or record of what has come out of it is on file.	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A startup proclamation created statutory designation, a grant programme and a credit-guarantee fund (proclamation). The Startup Proclamation 1396/2025, published in the federal gazette in September 2025, creates a designation for startups and for "ecosystem builders", a digital startup portal, a national startup designation committee, a startup grant programme, a credit-guarantee fund and a fund of funds (proclamation). The Addis Ababa e-mobility startup Dodai closed a US\$13m Series A in April 2026, US\$8m of equity and US\$5m of debt (announcement). The Artificial Intelligence University Innovation Pod was inaugurated in February 2026 with the AI institute, UNDP and Addis Ababa University, adding domestic research and incubation infrastructure (launch). The base holds no count of designated startups or of grants made under the new statute.	ADVANCED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	A national digital financial literacy campaign reached 525 civil servants drawn from 26 public institutions (campaign). The Ministry of Innovation and Technology, with UNCDF, ran a nationwide digital financial literacy campaign reaching 525 participants from 26 public institutions, targeted at women civil servants (campaign). The government set a target of 80% of government employees digitally skilled by 2030 under Digital Ethiopia 2030 (target). The earlier position was a mandate to develop civil-servant courses under the Digital Foundations project, whose digital-literacy and training-of-trainers activities were marked complete (aide-memoire). The base holds no measurement of how many civil servants have been trained against the 2030 target.	ADVANCED
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	The national coding initiative passed 5,005,146 enrolments, ahead of its target date (milestone). The 5 Million Ethiopian Coders Initiative passed its enrolment target ahead of schedule at 5,005,146 enrolments in programming, data analysis, Android development and AI fundamentals, and a 7-million target was set (milestone). Digital Ethiopia 2030 was launched in December 2025 with quantified population digital-literacy and internet-penetration targets, superseding Digital Ethiopia 2025 (launch); the government states these as 70% population digital literacy and 10 million citizens trained by 2030 (targets). The standing measured baseline is the 2022 national digital literacy maturity survey, on which 60.27% of those surveyed could use a computer, tablet or smartphone and 53.71% used the internet (survey, as cited in the education strategy). The base holds no repeat of that survey, so training enrolments are the only movement actually measured.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	A EUR21m programme to digitalise technical and vocational training launched, and a national digital-skills needs assessment was validated (DESTA). The DESTA initiative launched in November 2025 – EUR21m from Germany, the EU and Finland with the Ministry of Labor and Skills – modernising digital learning infrastructure and trainer digital competencies across TVET institutions in five regions (launch). UNESCO, the Ministry of Labor and Skills and the Federal TVET Institute validated a digital-skills training-needs assessment for TVET teachers and students in July 2026, identifying competency gaps and an action plan (workshop). The standing framework is the Digital Education Strategy 2023-2028, which sets digital-literacy objectives for teachers and students across general and secondary education (strategy). The base holds no count of TVET institutions reached or trainers certified under either.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	ETB 5bn was appropriated in the FY2026/27 budget to build an artificial intelligence university, with no site or timetable published. The appropriation is ETB 5,000,000,000, carried as a single named capital project in the federal budget ratified in July 2026 (budget line, budget ratified). Nothing is published on site, design, intake, faculty or opening date, and the base holds no enrolment figure, graduate count or course inventory for any digital qualification at any existing institution.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	The national coding initiative passed five million enrolments and a first artificial-intelligence startup cohort graduated (milestone). The 5 Million Ethiopian Coders Initiative, launched in July 2024, passed its target ahead of schedule at 5,005,146 enrolments, with a 7-million target set for August 2026 (milestone). The Ethiopian Artificial Intelligence Institute graduated the first cohort of a six-month AI startup programme, which exhibited solutions in healthcare, education, transport, language technology, smart cities, finance and human development (graduation). The Digital Foundations project's capacity-building component was rated satisfactory, with its own supervision recording that the impact needs to be systematically documented (aide-memoire). The base holds enrolments and graduations, not placements: nothing measures how many of these graduates enter the digital economy.	ADVANCED
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	A university law school is drafting the online-infringement amendment with the intellectual property authority. The amendment to the copyright proclamation is being drafted with the Addis Ababa University School of Law after several rounds of consultation (drafting). That is the whole of the record: no think tank, research centre or academic department is otherwise named as contributing to digital policy, and no commissioned research, submission or advisory appointment is held.	ADVANCED

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	A secure corruption reporting and case-tracking channel launched across the state holding company's portfolio (Adera). Adera launched in January 2026 as a secure corruption reporting and case-tracking channel for the public and for employees across Ethiopian Investment Holdings' portfolio companies, with anonymity and report tracking (Adera). The unified public service application was inaugurated in June 2026, described by the Prime Minister as bringing services from across institutions onto one platform, saving citizens' time and closing corruption gaps (inauguration). Both are channels into the state rather than published feedback: the base holds no complaint volumes, response times or resolution rates for either, so whether they function as feedback loops is not evidenced.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	A national dialogue conference of around 4,000 participants concluded in August 2026, deliberating eight national agenda items (conclusion). The Ethiopian National Dialogue Conference ran from 15 July to 22 August 2026 with around 4,000 participants deliberating eight national agenda items, and submitted its recommendations to the National Dialogue Commission (conclusion). The World Bank ran stakeholder consultations on its 2027-2036 country partnership framework across government, development partners, the private sector, civil society and regional governments, with an online window in May 2026 (consultations). The standing basis is constitutional: citizens have the right to participate in public affairs directly or through elected representatives, and government has a duty to promote participation in forming national development policies (constitution). The base holds participation events, not their effect: nothing records which recommendations were adopted.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Gender equity	The rural mobile-internet gender gap is put at 81%, against 29% in urban areas. The gap between men's and women's mobile internet use is reported at 81% in rural areas against 29% urban (gender gap). No earlier figure is held, so the level is on the record and the direction is not, and nothing is held on what is being done about it: no target, no programme and no gender-disaggregated figure for identity enrolment, account ownership or device access. 2026-09-03 - the corridor programme put training against formalisation rather than connectivity: forty women traders took export-readiness training at Bishoftu on 30 and 31 July 2026 under a EUR 32m European programme, covering formalisation, product standards, export documentation and customs procedure, against a stated 94% of the traders concerned operating unlicensed. That 94% is the programme's characterisation of its own target group, not a national measure.	NO CHANGE a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	Two national disability inclusion guidelines were disseminated, moving from policy development to mandated implementation (guideline). The national guideline for inclusion of persons with disabilities in skill development and employment was officially disseminated in February 2026, developed with the labour and skills ministry after a one-year review and moving from policy development to implementation across technical training and the labour market (guideline). A disability inclusion guideline for food security was launched at a national dissemination workshop in August 2025 and handed over to the women and social affairs ministry, the urban and infrastructure ministry and disability associations (workshop). The statutory basis is Ethiopia's ratification of the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities in 2010 (ratification). Neither guideline addresses digital access, and the base holds nothing on accessibility requirements for public digital services. 2026-09-01 — an operator foundation and the national federation of disability associations signed a three-year memorandum framing collaboration on digital inclusion, accessible technology, inclusive education, economic empowerment, healthcare and rights advocacy (memorandum). It is the first private-sector instrument on this indicator; the two guidelines before it were state ones, and no target, budget or beneficiary count is attached to any of the three.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	A refugee-inclusion framework covering 1.1m refugees and 2m displaced people makes the national identity central to a state-led model. The framework adopted in July 2026 puts the national identity at the centre of a state-led inclusion model covering 1.1m refugees and 2m internally displaced people (inclusion framework). The lender's March 2026 mission records about 190,000 refugee registrations against 170,000 identity issuances (aide-memoire). Neither figure is broken down by camp, region or status, and the base holds nothing on what services a refugee holding the identity can actually reach.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	A 1.5% revenue levy funds universal access, and handset financing targets up to two million smartphones a year. From March 2026 both operators contribute 1.5% of revenue to a universal access fund, about 2.5bn birr a year (access fund levy). Financing deals with two banks target up to two million handsets a year for low-income customers on long-term instalments (handset financing). A telco-agnostic wallet launched in December 2025 works on a subscriber module from any network and is verified against the national identity, removing network lock-in (the wallet). Nothing is published on what the access fund has disbursed, on how many handsets have been financed, or on the gap either is meant to close.	ADVANCED

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	The strategy of record is the second national statistics-development strategy, whose period ran to 2019/20 (NSDS II). The second National Strategy for the Development of Statistics, covering 2015/16 to 2019/20, was adopted by the Statistics Council and succeeded the 2009 first strategy (NSDS II). What moved in the window was legislative rather than strategic: the House of People's Representatives approved the Ethiopian Statistical Service Proclamation on 30 June 2026, intended to strengthen the service's independence and align the national statistical system with international principles (approval). No third strategy was located at the probe date of 28 August 2026, so the planning instrument has been out of period for six years while the statutory basis is being replaced.	NO CHANGE the strategy on the base expired in 2019/20 and no successor is held
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The fifth demographic and health survey reported (summary report); the census behind current population figures is still 2007's (census). The 2024/25 Ethiopia Demographic and Health Survey released its key indicators in January 2026 (key indicators) and its full summary report in July 2026, covering 22,540 households surveyed between August 2024 and April 2025 (summary report). The statistics service records three national censuses — 1984, 1994 and 2007 — and states that current population estimates are still projections from the 2007 census (census page). The base holds no date for a fourth census and no statement from the statistics service on when one will be held, so the survey programme is delivering against a population denominator that is now nearly two decades old.	MIXED the demographic and health survey reported in full while the population census remains that of 2007
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	The statistics service took the lead of a regional migration data working group under a signed data-sharing protocol (workshop). A three-day IGAD workshop operationalised the memorandum and Migration and Displacement Data Sharing Protocol signed by Ethiopian institutions in January 2025, with the statistics service empowered to lead the Migration Data Technical Working Group (workshop). The standing framework is the Code of Practice for Official Statistics, which expressly recognises administrative records, registers and government systems as sources of official statistics, assigning the statistics service the operational role and the planning ministry the regulatory one (code of practice). The base holds the mandate and one sectoral working group, and no count of which administrative systems actually feed published statistics.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Open data	Use of open data	The statistics service formalised public data access as a standing dissemination function (mandate). The Ethiopian Statistics Service now carries statistical data dissemination and access as a dedicated departmental function, covering its data bank, microdata repositories, web portals, anonymisation, public use files and dashboards (mandate). Ethiopia OpenAgriNet launched in February 2026 as an open-standards, consent-based agricultural data platform (launch). The last authoritative statement on the general-purpose portal is from 2018: data.gov.et launched in March 2016 with 29 datasets posted in open format, three of five planned citizen-facing applications delivered, and the open-data policy guideline still in draft (supervision report). The base holds no later status for data.gov.et and no dataset count for it after 2018, so what moved here are the sectoral platforms rather than the national portal.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	Ethiopian technical staff were trained on satellite crop and water monitoring platforms, and a supplier agreement for Earth-observation data was signed (workshop). A four-day workshop in Addis Ababa in June 2026 trained more than 50 technical staff from seven African countries, Ethiopia among them, on the CropWatch and ETWatch satellite crop and water monitoring platforms, covering crop condition, evapotranspiration and yield prediction; it was co-hosted by the Agricultural Transformation Institute and the Ethiopian Institute of Agricultural Research (workshop). Japan's Axelspace signed a memorandum with the Ethiopian firm Jethi Software Development in January 2026 to supply Earth-observation data and build a local utilisation framework — a private agreement, not government to government (memorandum). The standing government tool is LEAP, which converts satellite and ground agro-meteorological data into crop and rangeland production estimates and safety-net contingent-financing triggers (LEAP). The base holds no dated statement of LEAP's current operating status; the page describing it is undated.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data	An AI-driven multi-hazard early-warning system combining Chinese satellite products with local station data is being operationalised (interview). The meteorology institute's deputy director general describes the MAZU system, from the China Meteorological Administration, as installed, configured and being operationalised, combining FengYun satellite products with local station data for downscaled nowcasting, and as the first such deployment in Africa (interview). Addis Ababa is one of five pilot cities for the Urban Flash Flood Forecasting System, which combines satellite observations with nowcasting and was advanced at a regional workshop in March 2026 (workshop). The standing operational position is the institute's own satellite product set — natural-colour and dust imagery, precipitation rate, infrared imagery and rapidly developing thunderstorm nowcasting (products). The account of MAZU is the operator's own, carried by state media, with nothing on the base testing forecast performance.	ADVANCED

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	A United States health memorandum signed in December 2025 plans US\$1,016,000,000 of support to 2030 against Ethiopia's US\$450,000,000. The memorandum covers activities from April 2026 to December 2030, states at clause 6.9 that it is not an international agreement, and was signed on the Ethiopian side by the Minister of Finance (memorandum). The United States reserves 6% of the top-line budget for its own management and operations (the same text). It is the only United States or hyperscaler engagement held: no cloud provider agreement, technology company memorandum or bilateral digital instrument is on file.	ADVANCED
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	The country is a founding member of a Shanghai-based artificial intelligence body and opened vendor tracks on cloud and data centres in July 2026. Ethiopia is one of 29 founding states of the organisation, announced with 5,000 Chinese-funded training places over five years and support for joint open-source model development (founding membership). The constitutive text, membership list, powers, funding, voting rules and whether the agreement binds are all unestablished. The incumbent operator opened scoping discussions with its radio-network vendor covering cloud, artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, data-centre services and wallet integration, with no value or term disclosed (vendor scoping), and a separate data-centre track with a Chinese manufacturer, with no site or value stated (data-centre track). One Chinese model accounts for about 20% of chatbot use in the country, the top of its African range (model adoption).	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	The EU announced resumed budget support and a EUR150m digital economy package at the April 2026 business forum (announcement). At the EU-Ethiopia Business Forum of 20-22 April 2026 the EU announced the resumption of over EUR140m in budget support, a EUR150m digital economy package and EUR130m in new lending from the European Investment Bank, and noted results delivered under the EUR269m renewable energy and digitalisation programme (announcement). That programme was signed in September 2025 on the margins of the Africa Climate Summit, a EUR120m contribution from the EU and the French development agency to modernise power and digital infrastructure (signing). The governing framework is the EU's multiannual indicative programme for 2024-2027, adopted in September 2023 (programme). The digital economy package is an announced commitment; the base holds no signed instrument or disbursement against it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	A memorandum was signed between the two states' diplomatic academies, and technology appears as a dialogue theme rather than a commitment (dialogue). The second Hili Africa Dialogue concluded in Addis Ababa in June 2026, at which a memorandum of understanding was signed between the Anwar Gargash Diplomatic Academy and Ethiopia's Institute of Foreign Affairs for research and capacity-building cooperation; its sessions discussed expanding cooperation in the digital economy and artificial intelligence (dialogue). The standing bilateral position is the joint ministerial statement of 6 January 2026, which reaffirms a comprehensive strategic partnership and covers Sudan, the climate presidency and water, and names nothing digital (statement). A December 2025 ambassadorial meeting explored cooperation in trade, investment, renewable energy and technology, agreeing to maintain momentum through the Joint Ministerial Commission (meeting). The engagement is real and the digital instrument is not: no Gulf memorandum, investment or ministerial readout names Ethiopian digital infrastructure, artificial intelligence or payments.	ADVANCED on diplomatic and research cooperation rather than on any digital instrument
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	An Indian state rail telecom company announced a data centre build in January 2026, with nothing published since. The announcement is a press release from the Indian company stating an intention to build a data centre (announcement). No site, capacity, value, partner, timetable or Ethiopian counterparty is named, and the base holds no other Indian engagement, so the record is one press release and its silence since.	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Third mobile network operator licence	An Ethiopian Communications Authority licensing round, tender or ministerial decision on a third full operator licence.	2026-08-04
Gulf digital cooperation	An MoU, investment or ministerial readout naming a Gulf state counterparty in Ethiopian digital infrastructure, AI or payments.	2026-08-28
Audit of digital spending for any in-scope year	An Office of the Federal Auditor General report for EFY 2017 or later; its published library stops at EFY 2016.	2026-08-04
Independent data-protection safeguards over the national digital identity	a published data-protection impact assessment for the national digital identity, a statutory limit on state access to its data, or a redress mechanism a registrant could use	2026-08-09
National broadband strategy	A named national broadband strategy or plan, adopted by the Council of Ministers or the communications regulator, with targets and a period.	2026-08-28

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-09-08
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ETH/ETH-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ETH/ETH-progress-2026-09-08.pdf
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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.